AOU
الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

ID: _____

Name: _____

Faculty of Business Studies

LB170: Communication skills for business and management

FINAL EXAMINATION -Version B

Fall 2024- 2025

9-Jan-2025

Number of Exam Pages: 7 (including this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed: 3 hours**

PLEASE READ THE FOLLOWING INSTRUCTIONS

- This examination is composed of two parts. All questions are compulsory; you have to answer all questions.
- All the exam sections have to be answered on this exam paper.
- When you have finished, revise your answers in terms of content, language, and organization.
- Keep in mind that any form of cheating will not be tolerated and will subject you to AOU Cheating Policy.

Section	Allocated Marks for this question	EARNED Marks	Signature
Part I: Question A	10		
Part I: Question B	30		
Part II: Question A	30		
Part II: Question B	30		
TOTAL	100		

AOU EGYPT

CamScanner

This examination is composed of two parts. Answer all questions.

PART I (40 Marks)

a. **Read the sentences below and decide the function of each sentence by specifying which states a Hedging and which states a Boosting claim. Fill your answers in the blank boxes. (10 Marks)**

Sentence	Function
1. Renewable water management systems provide an effective strategy for addressing water scarcity in arid regions.	
2. Due to high labor costs, domestic demand for textile manufacturing is often met by imports from Southeast Asia, while a significant portion of domestic textile production is exported to international markets.	
3. Although more studies are required, it is hypothesized that the use of interactive educational tools in this study (i.e., those designed to enhance student engagement) might have influenced the improved learning outcomes observed.	
4. We propose that a strong focus on employee well-being is particularly advantageous for increasing productivity in workplaces where stress levels are typically high.	
5. One clear consequence of the growing importance of data privacy is that tech companies will likely need to invest more in secure data storage and encryption technologies.	

XOCEKPT

CamScanner

b. According to Schein (1980), teams form for both functional and psychological reasons. Complete the table with the functional and psychological reasons according to Schein theory. (30 Marks)

Functional reasons: 1. ..... 2. ..... 3. ..... 4. ..... 5. .....
Psychological reasons: 1. ..... 2. ..... 3. .....

AOU EGYPT

CamScanner

PART II (60 marks)

a. **Carefully read the below problem text and complete the following proposal sections. (30 Marks)**

- **Four proposed solutions.**
- **Four benefits of the proposed solutions.**
- **Two risks.**

Sunrise Retail Group, a regional retail chain headquartered in Atlanta, Georgia, operates 12 department stores across the Southeast. Committed to creating an inclusive workplace, Sunrise Retail Group implements a diversity-first hiring policy that focuses on recruiting individuals based on their skills and experiences, irrespective of their age or background.

However, Sunrise Retail Group faces significant challenges in managing labor shortages and meeting the increasing demand for their services. A primary issue is the inflexible scheduling system, which doesn't adequately address the needs of its diverse workforce, especially employees with families or those balancing multiple jobs. This rigid scheduling has led to high rates of absenteeism and difficulties in maintaining long-term staff.

Additionally, the wages offered to store associates are less competitive compared to other retail chains in the region. Many employees, particularly in sales and customer service roles, seek higher-paying opportunities elsewhere, resulting in frequent staff turnover. This turnover disrupts daily operations and affects the consistency of service that Sunrise Retail Group strives to offer its customers.

- **Proposed solutions:**

AOU EGYPT

CamScanner

- **Benefits of proposed Solutions:**

- **Risks:**

AOU EGYPT

CamScanner

vell written essay of around 300 words, answer the following question

b. Team working is one of the core skills for employability. According to Tuckman and Jensen's (1977) team go through five stages of development. Write an essay discussing the five stages of team development model and the communications skills associated with each stage. (30 Marks)

AOU EGYPT

CamScanner